

Murata Mfg. (6981.T): Conf call takeaways: Abundant factors to accelerate earnings toward 2H; Buy (on CL)

We hosted a conference call on June 22. Key points were as follows. **(1) MLCC order trends/capacity utilization:** High-level orders continue, and the BB ratio remains high, similar to the January–March quarter. In addition to strong demand for AI/DC applications, signs of a recovery are also emerging for automotive applications. Capacity utilization continues at 90–95%, in line with guidance. **(2) MLCC pricing strategy:** Management expects ASP improvements (re-pricing) driven by technological changes for AI/DC applications, but reiterated that it is not considering price hikes on a same-product basis at present. Conditions for future price hikes include (A) cases where orders further concentrate on Murata even outside of AI/DC (such as overflow from competitors' capacity limits or price hikes by other companies), and (B) cases of passing on cost increases. **(3) AI/DC-related sales:** The company indicated that its FY3/27 annual sales growth plan of +85–90% consists of +30–40% in volume and +50–60% in mix. **(4) MLCC capacity expansion:** Estimates of +10% in FY3/27 and +20–25% in FY3/28 (including +10–15% from additional expansion) are unchanged, but management's tone was that it wants to pull this forward as much as possible (with a possibility that some of the additional capacity will come online toward the end of FY3/27). In terms of the timeline, if the acceleration in AI/DC and recovery in other applications start to strengthen, further capacity expansion will need to be considered in late 2027. For AI/DC-related capacity expansion, the company is managing capacity by adding front-end processes in Japan and shifting some consumer and automotive capacity to overseas sites. Line conversion is being carried out for consumer applications but not for automotive applications.

In addition to the continuation of strong MLCC orders and a weaker yen relative to guidance, we feel that there are abundant factors to accelerate earnings toward 2H, including (1) further ASP/mix improvements in AI/DC applications, (2) containment of cost increase risks such as material costs, and (3) the possibility of further inventory accumulation accompanying capacity expansion. We will also monitor how automotive price revisions progress around the year end and if/when the company could proceed with considering price hikes on a same-product basis, from late 2026 into early 2027. We maintain our view that the MLCC cycle is still in its early stages and maintain our Buy rating (on CL).

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Murata Mfg.

Valuation methodology: We are Buy rated on Murata Mfg. (on CL) with a 12-month

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price target of ¥12,600. Our target price is based on FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying a 80% premium to our sector multiple of 10X (implies FY3/29E P/E of 30X).

Key risks: Decline in smartphone production volume, deterioration in MLCC supply/demand, and yen appreciation.

6981.T

12m Price Target: ¥12,600

Price: ¥12,220

Upside: 3.1%

Buy CL

GS Forecast

Market cap: ¥24.8tr / \$154.0bn	Revenue (¥ bn)	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Enterprise value: ¥24.0tr / \$149.0bn	Op. profit (¥ bn)	1,830.9	2,089.5	2,557.0	3,035.0
3m ADTV: ¥178.1bn / \$1.1bn	Op. profit CoE (¥ bn)	281.8	458.0	663.0	864.0
Japan	EPS (¥)	270.0	380.0	—	—
Japan Electronic	P/E (X)	128.5	206.8	310.7	420.0
Components/Semiconductors	P/B (X)	21.5	59.1	39.3	29.1
M&A Rank: 3	Dividend yield (%)	2.0	8.0	6.9	5.7
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No	N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	2.4	0.6	0.6	0.7
	CROCI (%)	(1.4)	(1.2)	(1.1)	(1.2)
		13.7	17.2	22.0	26.3
		3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
	EPS (¥)	42.1	45.0	53.0	56.7

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 22 Jun 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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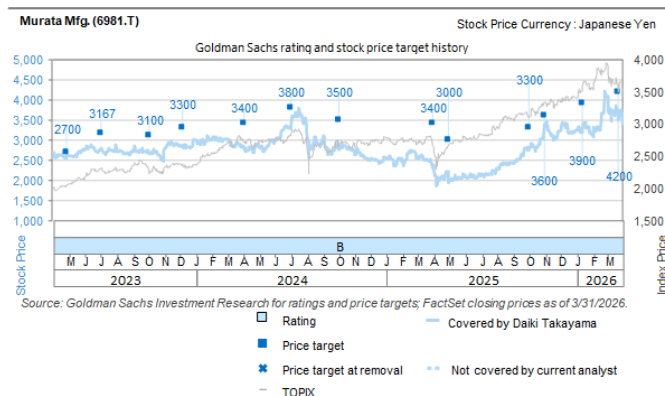
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Murata Mfg. (6981.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
08-Jun-26	12,600	8,711
30-Apr-26	5,400	5,156
23-Mar-26	4,200	3,508
12-Jan-26	3,900	3,194
31-Oct-25	3,600	3,392
02-Oct-25	3,300	2,770
30-Apr-25	3,000	2,214
31-Mar-25	3,400	2,306
01-Oct-24	3,500	2,893
02-Jul-24	3,800	3,364
03-Apr-24	3,400	2,768
06-Dec-23	3,300	2,892
04-Oct-23	3,100	2,657
04-Jul-23	9,500	2,778

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